

Day 82 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Economy & TN Dev. Admin. (5): India's FY26 Growth & Global Ranking

READING MATERIAL

Covers India's FY26 (2025-26) GDP growth performance and its current position among the world's largest economies.

Q: What was India's GDP growth rate for the full FY26 (2025-26) financial year, and how does this compare historically?

A: About 7.7% — the highest since the post-COVID rebound in FY2022. (Note: the World Bank's South Asia Economic Update estimated a close but slightly different 7.6% for the same period — a reminder that GDP estimates vary slightly by source/methodology.)

Q: What did an OECD report confirm about India's economic growth status?

A: India remains the world's FASTEST-GROWING MAJOR ECONOMY, and the fastest-growing economy among G20 countries — holding this position despite US tariff pressures and higher energy costs.

Q: What is India's current global ranking by nominal GDP, and by purchasing power parity (PPP), as of April 2026?

A: 6th largest by nominal GDP (around \$4.15 trillion); 3rd largest by purchasing power parity (PPP).

Q: What was a key driver of India's strong FY26 growth, per the World Bank?

A: Strong private consumption, GST rationalization (i.e., GST 2.0, covered in an earlier topic), and export resilience.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. India's GDP growth for the full FY26 (2025-26) financial year was approximately:

- A. 5.7%
- B. 6.7%
- C. 7.7% ✓**
- D. 8.7%

Explanation: About 7.7% — the highest since FY2022. [medium, web-research]

2. An OECD report confirmed India as:

- A. The world's largest economy by nominal GDP
- B. The world's fastest-growing major economy ✓**
- C. The world's most populous economy
- D. The world's most industrialized economy

Explanation: The world's fastest-growing major economy. [easy, web-research]

3. As of April 2026, India ranks ____ in the world by nominal GDP.

- A. 3rd
- B. 4th
- C. 5th
- D. 6th ✓**

Explanation: 6th (around \$4.15 trillion). [medium, web-research]

4. As of April 2026, India ranks ____ in the world by purchasing power parity (PPP).

- A. 1st
- B. 2nd
- C. 3rd ✓**
- D. 4th

Explanation: 3rd. [medium, web-research]

5. Per the World Bank, which of these was NOT cited as a key driver of India's FY26 growth?

- A. Strong private consumption
- B. GST rationalization

C. Export resilience

D. A sharp rise in crude oil prices ✓

Explanation: A sharp rise in crude oil prices (higher energy costs were a headwind, not a growth driver). [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Percentage

READING MATERIAL

Percentage is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. TNPSC's percentage questions are built from a handful of recurring shapes — successive discounts, reverse percentage ('20% of $x = 50$, find x '), percentage of a mixture, and percentage of a time period — recognize the shape first, then compute.

Q: Method — successive percentage discounts: A TV was sold for ₹14,400 after successive discounts of 10% and 20%. What was its original (market) price?

A: Successive discounts don't add (it's NOT a flat 30% off) — apply them one after another. If the market price is P : $P \times 0.90 \times 0.80 = 14,400 \rightarrow P \times 0.72 = 14,400 \rightarrow P = 14,400 / 0.72 = ₹20,000$.

Q: Method — percentage of a mixture (the parts must add to 100%): An alloy is 30% copper and 40% zinc, rest nickel. Find the nickel in 20 kg of the alloy.

A: Nickel % = $100 - 30 - 40 = 30\%$. Nickel amount = 30% of 20 kg = 6 kg. The key step is realizing the percentages must total 100% — nickel is whatever's left over, not a number given directly.

Q: Method — reverse percentage ('find the whole, given a percentage of it'): If 20% of $x = 50$, find x .

A: 20% of $x = 50 \rightarrow 0.20 \times x = 50 \rightarrow x = 50 / 0.20 = 250$. Reverse-percentage questions give you the part and the percentage, and ask for the whole — divide, don't multiply.

Q: Method — percentage of a decimal/small number: Find 0.75% of 40 kg.

A: $0.75\% = 0.0075$. $0.0075 \times 40 = 0.3$ kg. Common mistake: treating '0.75%' as '0.75' (i.e. 75%) instead of converting the decimal percentage properly — always convert to a decimal fraction first (divide by 100) before multiplying.

Q: Method — percentage of a time period: What percentage of a day is 10 hours?

A: A day = 24 hours. $10/24 \times 100 = 41.67\%$.

Q: Method — percentage of a fraction: What percent of $2/7$ is $1/35$?

A: Set up: $x\% \text{ of } (2/7) = 1/35 \rightarrow x/100 \times 2/7 = 1/35 \rightarrow x = (1/35) \times (7/2) \times 100 = (7/70) \times 100 = 10\%$.

Q: Method — sum of two independent percentage-of-number terms: Find the value of 28% of 450 + 45% of 280.

A: 28% of 450 = 126. 45% of 280 = 126. Sum = $126 + 126 = 252$. (A nice coincidence both terms equal 126 here — don't expect that in general, just add the two percentage values separately.)

Q: Method — percentage greater than 100% (the result is bigger than the original number): Find 280% of 3,940.

A: $280\% = 2.80$. $2.80 \times 3,940 = 11,032$. Percentages over 100% just mean the result is larger than the base number — the calculation method doesn't change.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A mobile phone was sold for ₹10,200 after successive discounts of 15% and 20%. What was its original price?

- A. ₹14,500
- B. ₹15,000 ✓**
- C. ₹15,500
- D. ₹16,000

Explanation: $P \times 0.85 \times 0.80 = 10,200 \rightarrow P \times 0.68 = 10,200 \rightarrow P = 15,000$. [medium, authored]

2. An alloy is 25% tin and 35% lead, the rest is copper. Find the copper in 40 kg of the alloy.

- A. 10 kg
- B. 14 kg
- C. 16 kg ✓**
- D. 20 kg

Explanation: Copper % = $100 - 25 - 35 = 40\%$. 40% of 40 kg = 16 kg. [easy, authored]

3. If 35% of $y = 91$, find y .

- A. 230
- B. 250
- C. 260 ✓**

D. 240

Explanation: $y = 91 / 0.35 = 260$. [easy, authored]

4. Find 1.25% of 80 kg.

A. 1 kg ✓

B. 10 kg

C. 0.1 kg

D. 12.5 kg

Explanation: $1.25\% = 0.0125$. $0.0125 \times 80 = 1$ kg. [easy, authored]

5. What percentage of a day is 6 hours?

A. 20%

B. 25% ✓

C. 30%

D. 16.67%

Explanation: $6/24 \times 100 = 25\%$. [easy, authored]

6. What percent of $3/8$ is $3/40$?

A. 10%

B. 15%

C. 20% ✓

D. 12%

Explanation: $x\%$ of $(3/8) = 3/40$, so $x/100 = (3/40) \div (3/8) = (3/40) \times (8/3) = 1/5$, giving $x = 20\%$. [medium, authored]

7. Find the value of 32% of 350 + 18% of 200.

A. 148 ✓

B. 138

C. 150

D. 146

Explanation: 32% of 350 = 112. 18% of 200 = 36. Sum = 148. [medium, authored]

8. Find 320% of 2,500.

A. 7,500

B. 8,000 ✓

C. 8,500

D. 9,000

Explanation: $320\% = 3.2$. $3.2 \times 2,500 = 8,000$. [easy, authored]

9. A quantity is first increased by 20%, then decreased by 20%. What is the net percentage change?

A. No change

B. 4% decrease ✓

C. 4% increase

D. 20% decrease

Explanation: Net change after +20% then -20% is always a decrease of $(20 \times 20)/100 = 4\%$ — increasing and then decreasing by the same percentage never cancels out, because the second change applies to a different (larger) base. [hard, authored]

10. The price of an item increases from ₹250 to ₹300. What is the percentage increase?

A. 15%

B. 20% ✓

C. 25%

D. 30%

Explanation: Increase = 50. Percentage increase = $(50/250) \times 100 = 20\%$. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Grammar: Articles, Subject-Verb Agreement (Concord), and Question Tags

READING MATERIAL

The dominant real-exam pattern here: many subjects LOOK plural or compound but are grammatically treated as singular ('Mathematics is...', 'Ten dollars is...', 'Each of the boys was...', 'Neither of the books is...') — don't just count nouns, check the actual grammatical rule.

Q: Real exam: "The list of items ____ on the desk." Which verb form is correct, and why?

A: Is — the subject is 'The list' (singular), not 'items' (the noun closest to the verb); 'of items' is just a modifying phrase.

Q: Real exam: "Either Ram or his brothers ____ coming today." Which verb form is correct, and why?

A: Are — with 'either...or'/'neither...nor', the verb agrees with the subject CLOSEST to it ('his brothers', plural), not the first-named subject.

Q: Real exam: "Everyone ____ ready for the exam" and "One of my friends ____ a pilot." Which verb forms are correct?

A: Everyone IS ready (indefinite pronouns like everyone/everybody/everything are always singular). One of my friends IS a pilot ('one' is the true subject, not 'friends').

Q: Real exam: "Mathematics ____ a difficult subject" and "Ten dollars ____ not enough." Which verb forms are correct, and why?

A: Mathematics IS a difficult subject (subjects ending in '-ics' naming a single field of study are singular, despite looking plural). Ten dollars IS not enough (a sum of money/time/distance treated as ONE single amount takes a singular verb).

Q: Real exam: "Neither the teacher nor the students ____ present." Which verb form is correct?

A: Were — again, the verb agrees with the NEARER subject ('the students', plural), not 'the teacher' (singular).

Q: Real exam: "The quality of the apples ____ not good" and "Neither of the books ____ interesting." Which verb forms are correct?

A: The quality IS not good (subject is 'quality', singular — 'of the apples' is just a modifying phrase). Neither of the books IS interesting ('neither'/'either' are always singular, regardless of what follows 'of').

Q: Real exam: "Each of the boys ____ given a gift." Which verb form is correct?

A: Was — 'each' (like 'every') is always singular, regardless of the plural noun that follows ('of the boys').

Q: Real exam: which sentence has an error in subject-verb agreement — 'The team has been working hard' / 'Time and tide waits for no man' / 'She don't have a pen' / 'He doesn't come outside nowadays'?

A: 'She don't have a pen' is wrong — it should be 'She DOESN'T have a pen' (third-person singular subject 'she' requires 'doesn't', not 'don't').

Q: Real exam: fill the blank with the correct article: "I saw ____ one rupee coin lying on the ground."

A: A (not 'an') — because 'one' starts with a consonant SOUND (/w/), the same sound-based rule as 'a university'/'an hour'. Articles follow the SOUND of the next word, not its spelling.

Q: Real exam: why should "He is a MLA" be corrected to "He is an MLA"?

A: Because 'M' is pronounced 'em' — a vowel SOUND — even though 'M' is a consonant letter. Same sound-based rule as the previous question, applied in the opposite direction.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The list of items ____ on the desk."

A. are

B. is ✓

C. were

D. being

Explanation: is. [medium, web-research]

2. "Either Ram or his brothers ____ coming today."

A. is

B. was

C. are ✓

D. has

Explanation: are (agrees with the nearer subject 'his brothers'). [medium, web-research]

3. "Everyone ____ ready for the exam."

- A. are
- B. is ✓**
- C. were
- D. be

Explanation: is. [easy, web-research]

4. "Mathematics ____ a difficult subject."

- A. are
- B. is ✓**
- C. were
- D. have

Explanation: is. [medium, web-research]

5. "Ten dollars ____ not enough."

- A. are
- B. is ✓**
- C. were
- D. have

Explanation: is. [medium, web-research]

6. "Neither the teacher nor the students ____ present."

- A. is
- B. was
- C. were ✓**
- D. has

Explanation: were (agrees with the nearer subject 'the students'). [hard, web-research]

7. "Each of the boys ____ given a gift."

- A. were
- B. have
- C. was ✓**
- D. are

Explanation: was. [medium, web-research]

8. Which sentence has an error in subject-verb agreement?

- A. The team has been working hard.
- B. Time and tide waits for no man.
- C. She don't have a pen. ✓**
- D. He doesn't come outside nowadays.

Explanation: She don't have a pen (should be 'doesn't'). [medium, question-bank-2025]

9. "I saw ____ one rupee coin lying on the ground."

- A. a ✓**
- B. an
- C. the
- D. no article needed

Explanation: a (one starts with consonant sound /w/). [hard, question-bank-2022]

10. Which is correct: "He is a MLA" or "He is an MLA"? Why?

- A. 'a MLA' — M is a consonant letter
- B. 'an MLA' — M is pronounced 'em', a vowel sound ✓**
- C. Either is acceptable
- D. 'the MLA' is required instead

Explanation: 'an MLA' — M is pronounced 'em', a vowel sound. [medium, question-bank-2025]